

Who are the gods and goddesses of the Urglaawe?

We share with other Heathen traditions the same pantheon of deities, though we believe that they continued to interact with us over the centuries; thus, our perceptions of (and interactions with) certain deities may differ somewhat.

Perhaps the best-known Urglaawe deity is the goddess Holle. Traditions related to Her were carried over the centuries in the ceremonial and oral lore of the healing practice of Braucherei. She is viewed as the matriarch of the German nation, including the Deutsch folk. She is the goddess of many things: the cycle of life, death, and rebirth among humans, animals, and the very soil.

Our lore also has always known Wodan, the powerful god of inspiration, poetry, and ecstasy; it was he who won knowledge of the mysteries of the universe, which we call the runes.

Dunner is the god whose great might we feel in thunderstorms. The lightning is his Hammer, the weapon with which he defends Mannheem, the world of humans; the rain that he brings makes the fields fruitful. Dunner's gentle consort, Siwwa, provides us with nutrients as represented in the bounty we reap from the fields.

Ziu is the upholder of right order and justice, both among humans and in the entire universe. Zisa removes complications and obstacles for just causes.

Frey is invoked for peace and plenty; His sister Freya rules over magic, sexuality, and riches. Their father Nodd, watches over the sea, ships, sailors, wealth, and trade. Frigg weaves the fabric of Wurt (fate) is the powerful defender of the home and hearth,

Kenna is the swift messenger goddess of Frigg's retinue. She is seen as an inspiration to surmount challenges and is a great resource for information during meditation.

These are but a few of the many Teutonic deities honored in Urglaawe. Please contact us for more information on our deities and on other aspects of our faith!

Do you have churches or congregations?

As is the case with most Heathen traditions, Urglaawe has no stringent dogma, though there are core principles that we share that draw us together. Instead of a congregation, we have a Sippschaft, which is essentially a group of people who share the same faith working to build a kindred together. This pamphlet is produced by the Distelfink Sippschaft, which is registered as a legal church in the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania.

Are there any national organizations?

As a tribal Heathen tradition, Urglaawe benefits from interacting on a national level with Heathens from related tradition. Many of us are members of organizations such as The Troth (www.thetroth.org), which serves as an excellent repository of Heathen lore and is a leader in research and personal development within Heathenry, including clergy training. The Troth believes that the Gods call whom they will—regardless of race, ethnic origin, gender, or sexual orientation. To hear their call is a joy, an honor, and also a duty. If you hear that call, and you are willing to live by our values and honor our Gods, then we invite you to take your place among friends and kin, and bring new honor and strength to our ancient Heathen faith.

How can I find out more about Urglaawe?

- Visit <http://www.urglaawe.org> or our ceremony recap site at <http://urglaawe.ning.com>
- Send an e-mail to us at info@urglaawe.org
- Join our active Hexenkunst Yahoo Group at <http://groups.yahoo.com/group/hexenkunst>
- Attend one of our events. Many regional public events for Urglaawe and other Heathen communities are listed on the website of the Asatru and Urglaawe Meetup of Eastern Pennsylvania and NJ: <http://asatru.meetup.com/249/>

Mach's Immer Besser!
(Make it always better!)

der Urglaawe



A Heathen Faith A Pennsylvania German Identity



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What is Heathenry? What is Urglaawe?

The Teutonic peoples of Northern Europe, who include the English, Norse, Icelanders, Swedes, Germans, and Dutch among others, once followed their traditional religion, with roots thousands of years old. Their ways were based on worshipping their deities, honoring their kin and ancestors, and respecting the Earth and the land spirits. Their beliefs were nearly wiped out during the conversion of the European nations to Christianity. Yet they did not die: in writings, traditions, and folklore, the old faith has survived to the present day. Various traditions and practices lived on among different Teutonic tribes, including some of the tribes that eventually merged together to form the Pennsylvania German (Deutsch) nation.

Today, a growing number of people are working for rejuvenation and a regrowth of these ways. We are not trying to “turn back the clock”: we live in the modern world, not the world of the Vikings or the Goths or the Anglo-Saxons. Yet our faith’s deep roots in history give us strength and courage, while its wisdom is deeply relevant to modern life. This is particularly true among the Deutsch nation, which is fortunate enough to have living traditions with Heathen roots from which we can grow.

In the old days, our religion had no name; it was just “the ways we’ve always had.” Today, different varieties of this religion are known by various names, including Ásatrú (pronounced AH-sa-tru, meaning “trust in the Gods” in Icelandic), the Elder Troth, Theodism, the Northern Way, and others. “Heathenry” or “Heathenism” is the most general term for our religion. The specific term for the faith in Deutsch is “Urglaawe” (pronounced “OR-glaw-veh”).

What are the ethical standards of the Heathen religion?

We strive to practice the moral principles followed by our forebears, as described in our oral tradition of Braucherei as well as through surviving folklore, epic poems, and sagas. Oftentimes we sum these up as the Nine Noble Virtues: Courage,

Truth, Honor, Loyalty, Discipline, Hospitality, Industriousness, Self-reliance, and Steadfastness. Urglaawer, as well as other Heathens, actively seek to apply these to every aspect of their lives.

How is Urglaawe different from Wicca and other pagan ways?

There are “Norse Wiccans” who practice Wicca in a context similar to Urglaawe, as do many eclectic Wiccans who are interested in the Deutsch traditions of Braucherei and Hexerei. Urglaawer do not consider themselves to be either Wiccans or neopagans. Many Wiccans see all gods as manifestations of just two deities, the God and the Goddess. Urglaawer, on the other hand, view their own deities as interrelated and working together, but not as aspects of a Godhead. We are generally polytheistic, not pantheistic or duotheistic.

Urglaawer generally don’t see their gods as identical with the gods of other peoples, such as the Greeks, Romans, Celts or Native Americans. The traditional paths of these peoples are valid for those who are called to follow them, but they’re not the same thing as Heathenry, and we don’t blend our religion with others.

Urglaawer also do not consider their faith to be fully reconstructive either, since it is the continuation of living traditions that have been practiced for centuries. We do, however, recognize that our form of the faith has evolved since the Christian conversion, and there are also many aspects of the old faith that require us to consult with the lore from related tribes. Thus, it is partially a reconstructive faith.

Are Urglaawer anti-Christian?

Most Urglaawer aren’t especially opposed to Christianity, as long as Christians respect our freedom of worship in return. Urglaawer recognize the existence of Jehovah, but he is a Hebrew tribal deity and thus not part of our pantheon. Thus, we reject the claim that he is the only valid god for all of humanity. Urglaawer don’t “worship Satan” or “worship demons” either. Satan, “demons” and “devils” belong to the Christian mythos and have

no place in Urglaawe. We also reject the doctrine of “original sin”; we may choose to do wrong, but wrongfulness isn’t built into our natures. We freely choose to follow our own path, and we ask that members of other faiths respect our choice.

Does Urglaawe support racism, homophobia, and Nazism?

No. Unfortunately, the Nazis used some Heathen symbols, such as the swastika and the runes, and appealed to the heroic past of the Germanic folk in their propaganda. A small number of outspoken racists and bigots continue to use Heathen beliefs and symbols as a cover for their political agendas. This is an ignorant and tragic misuse of our ancient birthright. (In much the same way, the Nazis misused some aspects of Christianity for their own purposes, and a few extremist groups such as the “Christian Identity” movement continue to do so.) There is no support in our myths and traditions for racism or for Nazi or other fascist ideology.

Urglaawer support the rights of all individuals to follow whichever religion and customs they choose, without interference or intimidation. We do not associate with known racists or would-be Nazis. We do not endorse their misuse of our symbols, such as Thor’s Hammer or the runes. And perhaps most importantly, we believe in taking honest responsibility for our own lives and our own societies. We don’t believe that it’s honorable to try to dump the blame for what we don’t like about ourselves onto Jews, Africans, gays, or anyone else.

What is the emblem on the cover?

The large picture is a sickle, which is representative of the goddess Holle. Sickle pendants are worn by Urglaawer as a tip of the hat to the ancient practice of Her adherents of carrying sickles as Her symbol.